

IPCC Tier 2 Livestock GHG Uncertainty Calculator

Getting Started with the AI-Assisted Data Translator

CIAT / CGIAR Alliance — ClimateActionNetZero

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A free AI assistant for translating your data into the app template

Filling the app's input template by hand can take several hours when your raw data isn't already in the right shape. The **GMH Uncertainty Translator** is a free Claude.ai assistant — loaded with the IPCC parameter catalogue, the template schema, and a library of mapping examples — that turns your own Excel or CSV files into a ready-to-upload template in roughly **10 minutes**. No installation, no payment.

Before you start

You will need:

1. Your raw inventory data file(s) — Excel, CSV, or even a PDF / screenshot of a table.
2. The filled **Pre-flight Questionnaire** (downloaded from the app's Resources tab).
3. About 10 minutes.

Step-by-step

1. Open [claude.ai](#) and sign in (free)

Go to [claude.ai](#) and click *Sign up* if you don't already have an account. The free tier is enough for this task. You can sign in with Google, email, or Apple — no payment details required.

2. Open the Translator Project

Click the shared link: **GMH Uncertainty Translator**

You'll land in a chat window pre-loaded with the parameter catalogue, template schema, and mapping examples. Claude already knows everything it needs to translate your data.

3. Paste your filled questionnaire as your first message

Open the questionnaire (.docx), select all, copy, and paste it as the first message into the Translator chat. Send.

Claude will briefly summarise back what it understood and ask which file(s) you'd like to upload.

4. Upload your raw data file(s)

Click the **paperclip icon** in the chat input box, select your file(s) — .xlsx, .csv, .pdf, or images of tables all work — and send. Claude will inspect the file, propose a column mapping, and ask you to confirm anything ambiguous.

5. Answer Claude's clarification questions

You'll typically see 2–5 short questions, e.g.:

- “Your column **weight** — is this body weight (current) or mature weight (adult target)?”
- “Your milk yield column is in litres — should I convert to kg using $\times 1.03$, or treat 1 L = 1 kg?”

Answer in plain language. Claude will adjust and re-confirm.

6. Receive the filled template

When Claude is satisfied, it will produce **filled_template_for_app.xlsx** as a downloadable file. Click the download icon next to it in the chat.

If Claude tells you the analysis tool is unavailable and instead gives you three CSV blocks (Inventory_Metadata, Parameters, Manure_Management), see the **Backup option** on the next page.

7. Upload into the Cattle Uncertainty App

In the app's **Data Input** tab:

1. Click *Upload your filled template (.xlsx)*.
2. Select **filled_template_for_app.xlsx**.

The app will validate the file and load it. Any issues appear in the **QA/QC** tab — **green** = OK, **amber** = review, **red** = fix.

You are now ready to run the uncertainty simulation.

Tips for a smooth session

- **Be specific.** “Population in column B is total dairy cattle in 2022” beats “B is animals”.
- **Tell Claude when something is wrong.** If a unit conversion looks off, just say “wait — that should be 275 kg, not 599 kg” and Claude will fix it.
- **Ask Claude to explain.** “Why did you set $Y_m = 6.5$?” is a fine question — it will cite the IPCC table.
- **Don’t worry about advanced parameters.** The 16 IPCC coefficients (C_{fi} , C_a , Y_m , EF_3 , ...) ship with sensible defaults. You only need to provide them if you have country-specific measurements.

Privacy

Claude.ai uses your messages and uploads in line with Anthropic’s privacy policy. For national GHG inventory data this is generally fine because the data is intended for public reporting under the UNFCCC. **If your ministry has a policy against uploading internal data to third-party AI services, do not use this tool** — fill the template manually using the parameter reference in the user guide instead.

Backup option — when the Project link doesn’t work, or Claude can’t generate the .xlsx

You can still get most of the value from any free AI chat:

1. Open any free AI chat: claude.ai, ChatGPT, Gemini.
2. Paste the contents of `param_catalogue.md` and `template_schema.md` (download both from the app’s Resources tab) as your first message, followed by:

“You are the GMH Uncertainty Translator. Use the schema above to help me convert my raw data into per-sheet CSV blocks. Ask me the standard six onboarding questions first.”

3. Paste your filled questionnaire and proceed as in Steps 4–5 above.
4. When the AI produces three CSV blocks (one per sheet), open the **blank template** (download it from the app’s Data Input tab) , paste each block into the matching sheet starting at row 4, save, and upload.

This is slower but works on any AI without the persistent Project.

When the AI gets it wrong

The Translator is a helper, not an oracle. Always:

- **Spot-check** the key numbers (population, body weight, milk yield) by comparing with your

original file.

- **Watch the QA/QC tab** for amber and red flags after upload — those highlight values outside IPCC ranges.
- **Tell us** when something is off. Use the in-app Feedback tab to report mistranslations so we can improve the prompt.

Produced by the CGIAR Alliance, Climate Action–Net Zero Initiative, Project D614 — GMH Emissions Uncertainty. Questions: M.Lolita@cgiar.org.